

Nonlinear Solvers

Overview

- compute the numerical inverse of a function using Newton's method
- compute partial derivatives and compute the first three terms of a Taylor series approximation for a function of multiple arguments
- identify the three terms for the Taylor series in terms of an approximation of a function multiple arguments
- relate Taylor series terms to tangent plane and critical points
- applying Newton's method in higher dimensions to solve a nonlinear system of equations
- the convergence challenges for Newton's method
- why Newton's method is not the complete solution for a nonlinear solver
- the data structures used for forward differentiation
- use numerical libraries that implement the forward differentiation approach

Async

Nonlinear Solvers in 1-D [Part 2](#)

Use Case

- probability density function for the **normal distribution** for a given center and **standard deviation**

$$f(x) = \frac{1}{\sigma\sqrt{(2\pi)}} e^{-\frac{1}{2}\left(\frac{x-\mu}{\sigma}\right)^2}$$

Probability
Density Function

- **probability** that a value is **less than** x

$$\Phi(x) = \frac{1}{\sigma\sqrt{(2\pi)}} \int_{-\infty}^x e^{-\frac{1}{2}\left(\frac{t-\mu}{\sigma}\right)^2} dt = \frac{1}{2} \left[1 + \operatorname{erf}\left(\frac{x-\mu}{\sigma\sqrt{(2)}}\right) \right]$$

Cumulative
Distribution Function

- where $\text{erf}(x)$ is a special function defined by

erf = error function

$$\text{erf}(x) = \frac{2}{\sqrt{\pi}} \int_0^x e^{-t^2} dt$$

Error Function

Invert

- to find the **inverse** we view it as a **root finding problem**

$$y = \text{erf}(x) \rightarrow f(x) = \text{erf}(x) - y = 0$$

- we need an **initial guess**, and for most x $\text{erf}(x)$ is close to x , so

$$x_0 = y$$

- for **Newtons method** we need the **derivative** of $\text{erf}(x)$, but that comes from the **fundamental theorem of calculus**

$$\text{erf}(x) = \frac{2}{\sqrt{\pi}} \int_0^x e^{-t^2} dt \rightarrow \text{erf}'(x) = \frac{2}{\sqrt{\pi}} e^{-x^2}$$

- which leads to the **iteration**

$$x_{n+1} = x_n - \frac{f(x_n)}{f'(x_n)} = x_n - \frac{\text{erf}(x_n) - y}{\frac{2}{\sqrt{\pi}} e^{-x_n^2}}$$

$$= x_n - \frac{\sqrt{\pi}}{2} e^{x_n^2} (\text{erf}(x_n) - y)$$

```
julia> using SpecialFunctions
```

```
julia> y = 0.5; x = y;
```

```
julia> x = x - \sqrt{\pi}/2 * exp(x^2) * (erf(x) - y)
0.47667241214786027
```

```
julia> x = x - \sqrt{\pi}/2 * exp(x^2) * (erf(x) - y)
0.47693624301317533
```

<https://specialfunctions.juliamath.org/v0.1/>

```

julia> x = x - \sqrt(\pi)/2 * exp(x^2) * (erf(x) - y)
0.4769362762044694

julia> x = x - \sqrt(\pi)/2 * exp(x^2) * (erf(x) - y)
0.4769362762044699

julia> x = x - \sqrt(\pi)/2 * exp(x^2) * (erf(x) - y)
0.4769362762044699

julia> erf(x)
0.5

```

Taylor Series in Higher Dimensions

Taylor Series

- function of **one argument** the Taylor Series

$$f(x) = f(a) + f'(a)(x - a) + \dots + \frac{f^{(n)}(a)}{n!}(x - a)^n + \frac{f^{(n+1)}(a)}{(n+1)!}(x - a)^{n+1}$$

- consider the case of a **vector valued function** of one variable

$$f : R \rightarrow R^n$$

- component by component, **vector valued derivative**

$$f : R \rightarrow R^m$$

$$f(t) = [t^2; t + \sin(t)]$$

$$f'(t) = [2t; 1 + \cos(t)]$$

$$f(t) = [a^2; a + \sin(a)] + [2a; 1 + \cos(a)](t - a) + \frac{[2; -\sin(a)]((t - a)^2)}{2!} + \dots$$

- Taylor Series in 2D**

- now we allow the **scalar** function to have **multiple** input arguments

$$F(x, y) = F(x_0 + (x - x_0), y_0 + (y - y_0))$$

- focus** on the **first** argument, and keep the **second** argument **fixed**

$$F(x, y) = F(x_0 + (x - x_0), y)$$

- now that we have a **function** of a **single** argument, apply the standard Taylor's Series

represents the tangent plane approximation of the function at the point (x_0, y_0) along the y -axis

as a function of y :

$$F(x_0, y) = \underbrace{F(x_0, y_0 + (y - y_0))}_{f(y_0 + (y - y_0))} = \underbrace{F(x_0, y_0)}_{f(y_0)} + \underbrace{\frac{\partial F}{\partial y}(x_0, y_0)(y - y_0)}_{f'(y_0)(y - y_0)} + \underbrace{\frac{\partial^2 F}{\partial y^2}(x_0, y_0) \frac{(y - y_0)^2}{2!}}_{\frac{f''(y_0)((y - y_0)^2)}{2!}} + \dots$$

constant linear term quadratic

Partial Differentiation:

by holding x constant, you treat the multivariable function $F(x_0, y)$ as a univariate function $f(y)$

this allows the use of standard Taylor expansion rules using partial derivatives $\frac{\partial F}{\partial y}$

by symmetry, the expansion along the x -axis is identical, substituting all y terms for x and holding y constant

a little busy

The Symmetry Rule

- the **Taylor expansion** for any **single variable** is performed by **holding all other variables constant** at the **anchor point** (x_0, y_0)

Axis of Expansion	Variable Held Constant	Resulting Univariate Function	First-Order (Linear) Term
y-axis	$x = x_0$	$f(y) = F(x_0, y)$	$\frac{\partial F}{\partial y}(x_0, y_0)(y - y_0)$
x-axis	$y = y_0$	$f(x) = F(x, y_0)$	$\frac{\partial F}{\partial x}(x_0, y_0)(x - x_0)$

Combine

- group by powers, and skip (x_0, y_0)

- the **single variables** start (along x)

$$F(x, y) = F(x_0, y) + \frac{\partial F}{\partial x}(x_0, y)(x - x_0) + \frac{\partial^2 F}{\partial x^2}(x_0, y) \frac{((x - x_0)^2)}{2!} + \dots$$

- the **full bivariate expansion** (all terms)

$$F(x, y) = F(x_0, y_0) + \frac{\partial F}{\partial x}(x - x_0) + \frac{\partial F}{\partial y}(y - y_0) + \frac{1}{2} \left[\frac{\partial^2 F}{(\partial x^2)(x - x_0)^2} + \frac{2(\partial^2 F)}{(\partial x \partial y)(x - x_0)(y - y_0)} + \frac{\partial^2 F}{(\partial y^2)(y - y_0)^2} \right]$$

- the **matrix wrap-up (quadratic form)**

$$F(x, y) = F(x_0, y_0) + \left[\frac{\partial F}{\partial x}, \frac{\partial F}{\partial y} \right] [x - x_0; y - y_0] + \frac{1}{2} [x - x_0, y - y_0] \left[\frac{\partial^2 F}{\partial x^2}, \frac{\partial^2 F}{\partial x \partial y}, \frac{\partial^2 F}{\partial x \partial y}, \frac{\partial^2 F}{\partial y^2} \right] [x - x_0; y - y_0]$$

Approximations

Tangent Plane

- Taylor Series in two dimensions for a scalar valued function is

$$f(x_0, y_0) + \left[\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}, \frac{\partial f}{\partial y} \right] \begin{bmatrix} x - x_0 \\ y - y_0 \end{bmatrix} + \frac{1}{2} \begin{bmatrix} x - x_0 & y - y_0 \end{bmatrix}^T \begin{bmatrix} \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x^2} & \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x \partial y} \\ \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial x \partial y} & \frac{\partial^2 f}{\partial y^2} \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x - x_0 \\ y - y_0 \end{bmatrix} + \dots$$

- approximations handles what happens close by
 - the point the second term shrinks faster than the first

$$f(x, y) = f(x_0, y_0) + \left(\frac{\partial f}{\partial x}(x_0, y_0), \frac{\partial f}{\partial y}(x_0, y_0) \right) \cdot (x - x_0, y - y_0)$$

$$z = a + (b, c) \cdot (x - x_0, y - y_0)$$

plane equation

$$\rightarrow -bx - cy + 1z = a - bx_0 - cy_0 = C$$

General

- this is **not limited to two dimensions**

$$F\left(\begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \\ z \end{bmatrix}\right) = \begin{bmatrix} \cos(x) + y \\ x^2 + 2y^2 - z \end{bmatrix}$$

nor does it require
the **number of input
arguments** to be the
same as output

$$F\left(\begin{bmatrix} x \\ y \\ z \end{bmatrix}\right) \approx F\left(\begin{bmatrix} x_0 \\ y_0 \\ z_0 \end{bmatrix}\right) + \begin{bmatrix} -\sin(x) & 1 & 0 \\ 2x & 4y & -1 \end{bmatrix} \begin{bmatrix} x - x_0 \\ y - y_0 \\ z - z_0 \end{bmatrix}$$

Jacobian